

TAB 18



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-280-23/24, Version: 1

Investment of Verizon Proceeds in Programs for Students in Foster Care and Experiencing Homelessness June 4, 2024

Student Health and Human Services, Student Support Programs

Action Proposed:

Approve investments of Verizon proceeds in programs for students in foster care and students and their families experiencing homelessness, by taking the following actions:

1. Authorize the waiver of Board Rule 1271 and corresponding Bulletin 6876.1, which has a limit of \$40 for personal gifts to students and parents/guardians for the purpose of implementing programs to support students in out-of-home foster care and/or students and their families experiencing homelessness, including, but not limited to, vouchers for food, clothing and supplies; access to laundry services; and enrichment experiences including field trips.
2. Adopt the following finding and statement of fact: “All expenditures of Verizon contract administration allowance funds as set forth in the Plan to Invest in Students in Foster Care and Experiencing Homelessness are in direct support of our district’s educational mission and serve the public interest. No funds shall be appropriated to any personal cause or purpose.”

Background:

In July 2019, Los Angeles Unified (LAUSD) entered into an agreement with Verizon Communications, Inc., helping the District to provide off-campus internet connectivity to thousands of students, closing opportunity gaps to participating in school. In May 2020, during the height of the COVID-19 pandemic, LAUSD amended the agreement to support its “Anytime-Anywhere Learning Initiative,” providing access to home internet for LAUSD students at the unprecedented monthly cost of \$10.00 per data plan. The amendment also allowed other K-12 school districts in the state to purchase data plans at this negotiated price to provide access for their own students. For every data plan purchased by an outside district, LAUSD would receive a one-time, per-unit ‘Contract Administration Allowance’ of \$5.00. To date, nearly a quarter million data plans have been purchased by other California school districts, bringing the total credit allowance for Los Angeles Unified to over \$1.2 million.

LAUSD plans to invest the accumulated contract administration allowance funds in programs that directly benefit students in foster care and experiencing homelessness. Programs include, but are not limited to:

- Mobile laundry services to families of LAUSD students experiencing homelessness or facing eviction
- Mini-grants to families of LAUSD students experiencing homelessness or facing eviction in the form of vouchers that can be used for a variety of necessities, such as food, clothing, hygiene products, and school supplies
- Field trips and enrichment experiences for students in out-of-home foster care or experiencing homelessness

Expected Outcomes:

In addition to addressing the technology needs of students in the District's most marginalized populations, investments in these key areas provide additional means of closing opportunity gaps commonly experienced by students living in foster care or experiencing homelessness, leading to increased school stability, attendance rates, school engagement, academic achievement, and graduation rates for these populations.

Board Options and Consequences:

The waiver of Board Rule 1271 and corresponding Bulletin 6876.1, which sets the limit of \$40 for gifts for students and parents/guardians, will eliminate any potential barriers to delivery of goods and services needed by these vulnerable populations to increase their success in school. Board approval of this motion will allow the release of much-needed funding to support students in out-of-home foster care or experiencing homelessness.

Policy Implications:

As a local education agency and agency of the state, LAUSD has the obligation to implement educational policies, operate public schools, and safeguard the educational, health and safety needs of all LAUSD students, staff, and communities within its geographic boundaries.

Budget Impact:

There are no budgetary changes in this plan that would negatively impact the District.

Student Impact:

This proposal is expected to yield positive results for students in out-of-home foster care or experiencing homelessness.

Equity Impact:

This proposal ensures students from traditionally disadvantaged populations have access to basic goods and services needed to attend school each day ready to learn.

Issues and Analysis:

With approval of this proposal, the Board expressly determines that the expenditures outlined herein are an appropriate expenditure of LAUSD funds in that they will benefit the education of its students and thus serve a legitimate, and approved, public purpose, within the scope of the District's jurisdiction and purpose.

Attachments:

Plan to Invest \$1.2M from Verizon to support Students in Foster Care

Informatives:

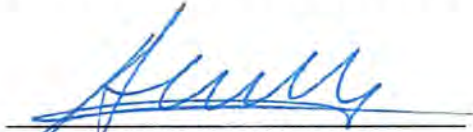
Not Applicable.

Submitted:

05/07/24

File #: Rep-280-23/24, Version: 1

RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,



ALBERTO M. CARVALHO
Superintendent

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:



ANDRÉS E. CHAIT
Chief of School Operations
Division of School Operations

REVIEWED BY:



DEVORA NAVERA REED
General Counsel

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:



JOEL E. CISNEROS
Administrator
Student Health and Human Services

☒ Approved as to form.

REVIEWED BY:



NOLBERTO DELGADILLO
Deputy Chief Business Officer, Finance

☒ Approved as to budget impact statement.

PLAN TO INVEST \$1.2 MILLION FROM VERIZON TO SUPPORT STUDENTS IN FOSTER CARE AND EXPERIENCING HOMELESSNESS

Los Angeles Unified and Verizon entered into an agreement whereby the District received a credit for every student who accessed the Internet using Verizon Broadband. To date, the credit balance stands at approximately \$1.2 million. Under the umbrella of Student Health and Human Services (SHHS), Student Support Programs, which oversees programs supporting youth who are in foster care or are experiencing homelessness, is proposing to invest these funds to enhance programs that support these student populations.

In recent years, Student Support Programs has provided an array of supports to students who are in foster care or are experiencing homelessness. Since the start of the COVID-19 pandemic:

- 6,965+ students who are in foster care or are experiencing homelessness were provided LTE Internet connectivity by the District (note: 6,965 is the number officially recorded in LAUSD's data system, but the number of hotspots and LTE iPads delivered to specialized populations was likely higher)
- 1,390 students/families were supported through the Student Support Programs extension of the Student and Family Wellness Hotline, which included targeted support for students in these populations
- 1,850 students in foster care or experiencing homelessness referred for priority enrollment at the Beyond the Bell Student Supervision Program sites
- 950 Lyft and Uber gift cards given to students in foster care or experiencing homelessness, and their caregivers, who were in need of transportation to schools, so they could access instructional materials/devices or the Grab and Go sites for meals, as well as to access basic need services
- 21 Virtual College tours attended by students in foster care and students experiencing homelessness
- 230 students in foster care were provided individualized on-to-one tutoring

Following is a detailed breakdown of how the \$1.2M in Verizon funds will be used to enhance this work.

Activity	Description	Timeline	Cost
Laundry Service	SHHS plans to help unhoused students and families maintain clean clothing by identifying families in need and paying for laundry services through.	The Laundry Truck LA would be available at all	104 weeks x 4 regions = 416 visits 416 visits x \$600 per day = \$ 249,600 (2 years)

Activity	Description	Timeline	Cost
	The Laundry Truck LA (TLTLA). This service enables families to drop off laundry, and then pick it back up, folded and sorted, a few hours later. The service would be ongoing to identified families experiencing homelessness or facing eviction.	The Laundry Truck LA would be available at all regions on a.	72 visits x \$600 per day= \$43,200 (year 3) Total: \$ 292,800
Mini-grants	SHHS plans to provide mini-grants (up to \$300 each) to support students in special populations. Grants may cover the following costs: ● Transportation ● Basic needs (clothing, shoes, & hygiene, via store gift cards) ● Food insecurity (prepaid store cards) ● Business attire for job interviews ● School/student incentives (e.g. attendance incentives) ● School supplies ● Academic achievement/celebrations ● Extracurricular school activities & fees (e.g. parking fees to a FAFSA workshop, additional PE uniforms)	Grants would be awarded on a monthly basis over 3 years.	Up to \$300 per grant: At minimum we will issue a total of 482 grants per year Budget: \$146,666.67/year Total: \$ 440,000
Field trips	In partnership with Beyond the Bell, SHHS would offer Day of Discovery Field Study Programs to identified students in special populations. Day of Discovery Field Study Programs has long standing partnerships with non-LAUSD sites throughout the Los Angeles area to make real-world, hands-on learning experiences accessible to students.	Field Study Programs will be offered on a monthly basis over 3 years.	Up to 10,000 students on up to 166 trips over the course of the three years Field Study Programs range from \$80 to \$1000 per day

Activity	Description	Timeline	Cost
			Transportation: \$500 per bus (30 students per bus) Total: \$ 517,920
Indirect Costs			\$ 13,810
TOTAL COST			\$1,264,530